CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

# FRANCHISE OWNER (HOME SERVICES) IN THE AI ERA

Buy the playbook instead of writing it: brand, systems and phone that rings — for a fee, forever.

**★ TL;DR — Around $75K a year for an owner-operator who works the system, built over 6–12 months including discovery and training. The catch: you are buying a job with rules and royalties — the franchisor's success is not your territory's success. ★**

## THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

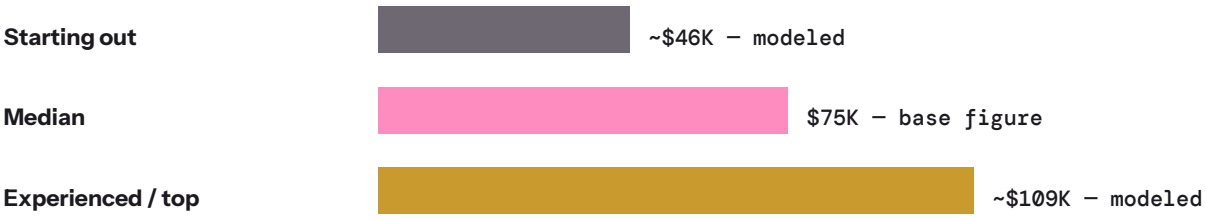
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 6-12 months · AI RISK LOW · CERTIFICATE

- You skip the blank page: pricing, branding, training and software arrive in a box.
- Royalties and marketing fees skim every dollar forever — the model must still work after the skimming.
- Your real job is the same as any home-services owner's: hiring techs and keeping customers.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

## THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS




The Career Glitch base figure for Franchise Owner (home services) is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

## WHAT DOES A FRANCHISE OWNER (HOME SERVICES) ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Run local marketing inside the brand's rules and sell jobs in your territory
- ✓ Hire, train and schedule technicians or crews
- ✓ Deliver the service standard the brand inspects you on
- ✓ Manage reviews, callbacks, cash flow and the franchisor relationship

Think: renting a restaurant recipe that works — you still cook, staff and clean, and the landlord takes a cut of every plate.

## WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

| THE ROBOT | THE HUMAN |
|---|---|
| The brands automate the middle: AI call answering, dispatch, estimating support and review management are rolling into franchise systems — owners who use them run leaner. | Local trust stays human: the tech a homeowner lets in, the callback you redo for free at 7 p.m., the crew member you coach instead of firing. Franchises sell systems; neighborhoods buy people. |

⚠ **The Franchise Disclosure Document is where the truth lives — fees, failure rates, territory limits — and it is hundreds of pages nobody reads at their peril. A great national brand can still fail in your zip code.**

## THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

| THE JOB IS | THE JOB IS NOT |
|---|---|
| ✓ Faster start than building a brand from zero<br>✓ Training, peers and a playbook when problems hit<br>✓ A sellable business with a known brand at the end | ✗ Franchise fee up front, royalties forever<br>✗ Rules about pricing, suppliers and marketing are not suggestions<br>✗ Your territory's ceiling is drawn on somebody else's map |

Good fit? A disciplined operator who executes proven systems better than they invent new ones — and who reads the FDD like a contract, because it is.
Bad fit? You chafe at rules, want to set your own prices and suppliers, or you are signing because the discovery-day presentation felt exciting.

## THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

| DOOR A — NEW TERRITORY, OWNER-OPERATOR | DOOR B — RESALE FRANCHISE OR MULTI-UNIT |
|---|---|

| | |
|---|---|
| The standard route: buy an available territory in cleaning, painting, junk removal or similar, train with the franchisor, and work in the business daily at first. Your sweat is part of the financing — plan for it. | Buy an existing franchise from a retiring owner — real customers and staff, at a real price — or enter with capital to run multiple territories semi-absentee. More money, more management layers, same royalties. |

Smart move: Call twenty existing owners — including ones who closed — before you call the salesperson again. The FDD lists them. Owners tell you the numbers the brochure rounded. Where you land after: A multi-crew territory with a manager — then a second brand or territory, or an exit sale to the next operator.

## YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| DECIDE WHAT | READ THE | INTERVIEW OWNERS, | VERIFY YOUR | FINANCE AND | LAUNCH BY |

### STEP 1 — Decide what you are actually buying

FREE · 2-4 WEEKS

- List what the franchise truly provides: brand demand, systems, training, buying power — and what it does not: customers, staff, guarantees.
- Set your total budget including working capital for the ramp, not just the franchise fee.

### STEP 2 — Read the FDD like a detective

FREE · 2-4 WEEKS

- Study the full fee stack, territory terms, renewal and exit rules, and the financial performance section if one exists.
- Note every owner name in the disclosure — your interview list for the next step.

### STEP 3 — Interview owners, including ex-owners

FREE · 2-4 WEEKS

- Ask about real ramp time, hidden costs, franchisor support quality and what they wish they had known.
- Believe patterns across twenty calls, not the two happiest voices the salesperson suggests.

### STEP 4 — Verify your territory

FREE · 2 WEEKS

- Count your actual households, competitors and price levels; the map in the brochure is not a market study.
- Check required local licenses and insurance for the service itself — the franchise does not waive your state and city rules.

### STEP 5 — Finance and sign with counsel

FRANCHISE FEE · MONTHS 3-5

- Have a franchise attorney review the agreement before signing — this is the cheapest protection in the whole deal.
- Line up the full capital stack: fee, vehicle, equipment, insurance and months of runway.

### STEP 6 — Launch by the playbook, hire ahead

PAID · MONTHS 5-12

- Complete training, open with the brand's launch marketing, and recruit your first techs before the phone rings loudly.
- Track the metrics the best owners watch: booked rate, average ticket, callback rate, review count.

## FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

□ Today: write down what you think a franchise actually buys you — then plan to verify every line.

□ Days 1–30: read the full FDD of your top candidate and build the owner-interview list.

□ Days 31–60: interview owners weekly, verify your territory's real demand, model the fee-stripped margins.

□ Days 61–90: attorney review, financing lined up, decision made on numbers — sign or walk with a clear head.

□ Day 90: either in training with eyes open, or out with your capital intact. Both beat signing on a feeling.

## NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

**★ BUY THE SYSTEM. VERIFY THE NUMBERS. ★**